



YOU ARE **6 WEEKS AND 3 DAYS**

235 days to go

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### YOUR BABY TODAY

The eyes begin life as shallow depressions, one on each side of the developing face. This image shows an early eye in the center right, together with the curve of the pale yellow somites of the developing musculoskeletal system.

“Needing to urinate frequently is, unfortunately, one of the unwanted side effects of pregnancy.”

Are you spending a lot of time in the bathroom? In addition to dealing with symptoms such as [nausea and vomiting](#), if you're like the majority of pregnant women, you'll need to urinate more frequently. It means you're unlikely to want to be too far away from the nearest bathroom.

It can feel as though your bladder cannot hold much urine so you may feel the need to go to the bathroom not long after you've just been, during the day and at night. This is because there is more blood being pumped through the kidneys so you produce more urine. As your uterus grows, it puts pressure on your bladder so it cannot expand as much as normal and will feel uncomfortably full earlier than usual. This can last throughout pregnancy, though you're most likely to experience it in the first and third trimesters.

If, however, you're concerned about the amount of urine you're passing, and/or develop pain or stinging while passing urine, you may have developed a urinary tract infection and should see your doctor immediately.

### KNOW YOUR CARBS

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**Make carbohydrates part of your balanced diet**, but choose the right ones. Complex carbohydrates, such as whole grains, provide fiber that your body breaks down slowly, releasing glucose into the bloodstream gradually. These are low glycemic index (GI) foods. Other carbohydrates are metabolized quickly (high GI); examples are white bread and rice, mashed potatoes, and high-sugar products. These make the body release more insulin to control blood sugar. This is not good for you or your unborn baby. Fluctuating glucose and insulin levels may lead to gestational diabetes as well as influence the growth of the placenta and baby. Don't restrict your intake of carbohydrate-rich foods such as pasta, rice, grains, breakfast cereals, and bread because your baby is constantly drawing glucose from your bloodstream, so a steady release of glucose leaves you both with plenty of fuel. However, choose whole grains, such as quinoa, millet, and barley, opt for whole-wheat pasta and brown rice, and enjoy oatmeal or muesli for breakfast. The fiber will also help keep you feeling full and prevent constipation.